- The **minimum** daily return was a painful -12.2% loss
- The **maximum** daily return was a 7.9% gain
- The **median** (50% point) is slightly positive, suggesting more up days than down days

Just these few statistics start to paint a picture of Apple's stock behavior—moderate volatility with a slight upward bias, but occasional significant drops.

*?? **Did You Know?** When Jim Simons was building what would become Renaissance Technologies (now the world's most successful hedge fund), he insisted that his team thoroughly analyze basic statistical properties of financial data before developing any trading strategies. This approach was radical on Wall Street in the 1980s, where traders relied more on intuition than statistics. One of Renaissance's early discoveries—that many financial returns weren't normally distributed but had "fat tails" (meaning extreme events were more common than expected)—gave them a significant edge in risk management. Today, their Medallion Fund has generated around 66% annual returns (before fees) over more than 30 years, largely because they understood the statistical properties of their data better than competitors.*

Beyond simple descriptive statistics, we can gain deeper insights by examining:

- **Skewness**: Measures asymmetry in the data distribution. Negative skew means more extreme negative returns than positive ones.
- **Kurtosis**: Measures the "tailedness" of the distribution. High kurtosis indicates more frequent extreme values.
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